



Evernote 5 for Windows

The company released its beta version with a new look and a slew of other features. Tried it yet?



VIP identification software

Facial recognition software by NEC aims to identify celebs by data from real-time CC TVs to notify hospitality staff for immediate doting service.

Camera Test

which means that if you're filming someone talking on a busy street, be prepared to get a lot of ambient noise, and if it's windy, there's a good chance your audio will not be barely audible.

If shooting videos is a major part of your relationship with your camera, then we'd recommend opting for the Nikon S9500, as it delivered the cleanest footage of them all, in full HD with audio recorded using stereo microphones.

FEW MORE CONSIDERATIONS

While imaging performance, build quality and ergonomics are extremely important factors to take into consideration while buying a camera, one feature that often goes unreported is the responsiveness of the camera. You don't want to be in a situation where your little one is taking his first step and you pick up the camera to take a shot of this memorable moment, only to find that the camera takes too much time between starting up and taking the first shot.

We measured the responsiveness of each camera, measuring startup times, time till first shot and even how quickly the camera responds to the push of a menu button

and how quickly it can exit from it etc. The Panasonic SZ3 was surprisingly quick in doing everything it was told, with the only drawback being a poorly designed menu (which may slow you down). The Canon Ixus 255 and Ixus 500 were speedy, but faced some problem in locking focus right after starting up. The Nikon S5200 was a little slow to startup and shoot, but the S6500 didn't stutter at all. The fastest camera, in our opinion, was the Canon SX240 HS. The camera is pretty much ready to shoot the second you press the power button, unless you want to zoom or are shooting on Macro.

When we consider speed, one thing to keep in mind is that when shooting Macro mode, the AF on most cameras does slow down. There is nothing wrong with that, as the lens is cycling through a longer focusing range at a much finer setting to lock onto the closest subject. That being said, we found shooting in Macro mode with most of these cameras quite frustrating as there was no way to get them to focus on the exact spot we wanted them to focus on. Patience, dear readers, is key here.

VERDICT

The shootout has been an enlightening one, showing that even though the size of the sensor in all these cameras is exactly the same, their performance varies. A lot of it has to do with the algorithms in the image processing chips, the quality of the lenses and

we proudly award the S5200 the Best Buy Award.

The Canon Ixus 255 HS is a camera that throughout our testing made quite an impression on us. It wasn't the top of the class, and neither was it the cheapest. However, it was a camera that slipped very comfortably into our pants,



Nikon S6500

of course, the size of the individual pixels on the sensor themselves.

In terms of pure performance, we found that the Nikon Coolpix S6500 was best overall, with excellent colour reproduction, good contrast levels and a decent dynamic range. The video from this camera is also much better, thanks to the sensor being able to capture full HD footage along with the stereo microphones providing the audio. For this, we award the Nikon Coolpix S6500 the Best Performer Award.

If pure performance isn't your thing, and you are a little more price conscious, then you might want to look at another option. For about ₹3000 less, you can have the S5200. It's smaller than the S6500, slightly lighter too and performs almost just as good – no problems at all. Thanks to the good balance between price and performance,

was responsive and did take good every-day photos. Its compact, its light and it didn't let us down in any way. If we were to recommend a camera for everyday-average "upload-to-social-media" use, we'd more than likely recommend this little guy, and for that, we award it the Editor's Choice Award.

So these are the three winners in our shootout for this month. We are disappointed that Sony could not participate in our shootout, as we have seen the company produce some amazing cameras at unbelievable price.

Regardless, the cameras we have tested here are a really good set to choose from, while our Best Buy, Best Performer and Editor's Pick are the cream of the crop, you would be pretty satisfied with the way any of these cameras perform. It's not a price bracket to expect amazing performance, obviously. **A**



Canon Ixus 255 HS